

Part 1

Read Passage One and answer questions 1-6 in the Question-Answer Book.

Passage One:

'Secret squad' of Asian elephants

- 1 [1] A family of Asian elephants have aided Chinese authorities in the arrest of five suspects in south-western China's Yunnan province who were trying to cross the border illegally.
- [2] Last week, police in Xishuangbanna Dai autonomous prefecture received reports from local residents that several wild Asian elephants were walking on a highway, news agency Xinhua reported.
- 5 [3] Officers soon arrived at the site along with elephant monitoring officials and sealed off the road and surrounding area near the border with Laos.
- [4] While they were using an infrared thermal imaging drone to track the elephants, they were surprised to see the thermal signatures of five people behaving suspiciously in the forest near the road.
- 10 [5] When the officers approached them, they fled. The police immediately pursued them and to their surprise the elephants began following the five suspects as well.
- [6] The officers followed the tracks of the elephants whose large bodies left a clear path through the thick forest. The suspects were about one kilometre away from the border between China and Laos and there were just 200 metres between the elephants and the suspects.
- 15 [7] The police caught three of the suspects thanks to the elephants. The other two were arrested several hours later. The group told police they were on their way to cross into Laos when they were caught. "These elephants are smart. Well done!" wrote one user on Weibo. "They are an elephant secret squad. They are _____," another commenter wrote. "Last year, the elephants ate a lot of farmers' food. Now it's time for them to repay society," a third person said.
- 20 [8] The last comment referred to the herd of more than a dozen Asian elephants which gained worldwide popularity last summer after trekking 500 kilometres northwards to the suburbs of the provincial capital of Yunnan, Kunming, before returning to their original habitat in Xishuangbanna.
- [9] During their months-long journey, the elephants often foraged in villages and damaged farmers' crops. To avoid conflicts between the elephants and humans, the provincial authorities evacuated 150,000 residents and provided 180 tonnes of food for them to eat.
- 25 [10] Statistics from China's National Immigration Administration showed that about 47,000 people were arrested for sneaking in or out of the country, and 2,500 crime rings organising illegal border crossings were shut down last year.

Passage Two:

Learn the art of being alone

1 [1] Our world often says that if we want to be well-liked, we should make sure to be around friends all the time. But did you know being alone can actually be beneficial for you and even your social life? Ken Fung, director of therapy and counselling at Jadis Blurton Family Development Centre in Hong Kong, clears up misconceptions associated with alone time and encourages everyone to cultivate the habit of spending time on their own. So why
5 would anyone choose to put a pause on socialising when it seems like it could lead to feelings of emptiness?

[2] That is what most people get wrong, said Fung, a clinical psychologist. He set the record straight about the difference between spending time alone and feeling lonely. While the former is a choice, loneliness is a condition marked by feelings of disconnectedness, and we can feel lonely even when we are surrounded by people.

10 [3] "Our minds are constantly engaged with different sorts of mental activities, which can be categorised under 'doing' and 'being'," explained the psychologist. Usually, we are in "doing" mode, which refers to the actions we take to achieve our goals. While this has benefits, it can take a toll on our mental health if it is the only mode in which we spend all of our time. He added: "The very much overlooked 'being' mode helps us to be aware of what is happening in the present moment, and this involves spending time alone so that we can connect to our thoughts and our emotions. Everyone needs this ... whether they are introverts or extroverts." Fung said many
15 people often feel embarrassed to admit they need time on their own because of society's bias against introversion. We have been taught that being alone is a sign of a failed social life.

[4] However, Fung emphasised that this could not be further from the truth. "Introverts are not asocial as many have been led to believe. Rather, they just consume and recharge their energy in ways that are different to extroverts," he said. According to the psychologist, introverts tend to recharge when they are by themselves, and
20 they can feel drained when spending too much time around others. The opposite is true for extroverts, but they do benefit from being on their own, albeit for shorter periods.

[5] The ability to tolerate alone time had been linked to increased happiness and improved stress management, Fung pointed out. People who enjoy spending time by themselves experience less depression, too. Other benefits of solitude include building self-awareness and self-confidence. This is especially helpful for teens who are still
25 undergoing emotional development and are seeking acceptance from their peers. "They will make it a point to line up the schedule with fun, cool activities to avoid spending time alone even for one weekend," Fung said, adding that despite the allure of wanting to constantly make plans, alone time could help teens feel more confident when socialising. "Being alone actually helps you to become more comfortable in your own skin and allows you to make choices without outside influences. This gives you the chance to reflect on who you really
30 are," he explained.

[6] To cultivate the habit of alone time, Fung recommended starting with baby steps such as setting aside an hour every day for reading or watching your favourite Netflix shows. In all, life is about balance. Fung referred to the Japanese concept of yohaku no bi, which celebrates the beauty of white space in a work of art. "For a painting to be balanced, there must be some void spaces so that the viewer will know which parts of the artwork to focus
35 on," he said. "In the same way, this is true for our social life. It is only when you are comfortable with yourself that you can gain self-confidence and ... learn to better connect with others."

END OF READING PASSAGES

**FORM 3****GENERAL ENGLISH****QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK**

Name: _____

Class: _____

Class Number: _____

Set 2**Part 1 – Reading Comprehension (30 marks)****For each multiple-choice question, darken the appropriate circle. Otherwise, no mark will be awarded.****Passage One (16 marks)**

1. Find an expression in paragraphs 1 to 5 which shares the same meaning as each of the phrases below. (3 marks)

(i) independent and having the freedom to govern oneself _____

(ii) prevented people from entering an area _____

(iii) the use of a technology to create a picture based on the heat produced by a person or object, generally in conditions in which it is difficult to see _____

2. Which expression below is most suitable for the blank in paragraph 7?

- A. criminals
 B. crime-ridden
 C. crime-busters
 D. criminal damage

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

3. Use the information in the article to decide whether the following statements are True, False or Not Given. (5 marks)

(i) Police in north-western China have praised a family of wild Asian elephants who followed five suspects and led to their arrest.

T F NG
☐ ☐ ☐

(ii) The gang followed the elephants towards the Laos border, allowing officers to pursue and arrest them with ease.

☐ ☐ ☐

(iii) Thermal imaging technology is often used to track elephants in China.

☐ ☐ ☐

(iv) The police managed to catch all five suspects simultaneously.

☐ ☐ ☐

(v) According to statistics from China's National Immigration Administration, more than 45,000 individuals were detained for entering or leaving the country illegally last year.

☐ ☐ ☐

4. What does 'the herd' in line 19 refer to?

5. Which word in paragraphs 8 and 9 refers to areas on the edge of a large town or city?

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

6. Based on the information in paragraphs 8 and 9, complete the timeline of events by writing ONE word in each blank. You should make sure your answers are grammatically correct. (5 marks)

Last summer, over a (i) _____		The elephants frequently foraged in villages on their (iii) _____ trek,		The provincial government ordered the (v) _____ of 150,000 inhabitants and gave 180 tonnes of food for the elephants to eat in order to prevent confrontations between people and the elephants.		The elephants went back to their home in Xishuangbanna.
Asian elephants travelled 500 kilometres north to the outskirts of Kunming, the Yunnan province's (ii) _____.	>	(iv) _____ farmers' crops.	>		>	

Passage Two (14 marks)

7. What does 'former' in line 7 refer to?
- _____
8. According to the article, which word best describes most people's attitude toward spending time alone?
- A. sentimental
B. indifferent
C. biased
D. accepting
- A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
9. What can happen if we spend a prolonged period of time in the "doing" mode?
- A. We learn to communicate with our thoughts and feelings.
B. We feel more comfortable in our skin.
C. We may experience detrimental effects on our mental health.
D. We start to fear being a social failure.
- A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
10. Use the information in the article to decide which of the following statements are said by Introverts or Extroverts. Put a tick (✓) in the correct box. (3 marks)

	Introverts	Extroverts
(i) I feel worn out when I spend a lot of time with others.		
(ii) I get energised when surrounded by other individuals.		
(iii) To recharge myself, I require some solitary time.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

11. Why might teens be particularly hesitant to spend time alone? (2 marks)

12. What example did the writer use to illustrate the importance of maintaining balance in life?

13. Below is a summary of the article. In four of the lines, there is ONE mistake. If you find a mistake, underline the mistake and replace the word with one that expresses the correct idea. Write the word in the space on the right. If there is no mistake, put a tick (✓) in the space. The first has been done for you. (5 marks)

	Summary	Correction
e.g.	Being alone is a <u>coincidence</u> while loneliness is a state characterised	choice
(i)	by feelings of disconnectedness. Both teenagers and	
(ii)	extroverts need to spend time in "doing" mode to be conscious of	
(iii)	the past, and to connect with their feelings and ideas.	
(iv)	By reserving one hour each week for solitude, people might	
(v)	begin to form the habit of alone time.	

END OF PART 1

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Part 2 – English Usage (70 marks)

A. Verb Forms (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the words provided in brackets in their correct forms.

Selfless, loving and eternal – a mother’s unconditional love is said to be the most beautiful thing in the world. To thank the person who brought them into this world and raised them, people throughout history and across the globe (1) (celebrate) Mother’s Day in different forms.

But not every country (2) (observe) it on the same day, and different celebrations around the world have their own stories and origins. Read on to learn more about how the time to honour mothers and women traces back to the era of the ancient Egyptians and Greeks.

When is Mother’s Day?

The answer to this question (3) (depend) on where you are from. Like many places, including the US and Australia, Hong Kong celebrates Mother’s Day on the second Sunday of every May, which this year falls on May 8.

In other countries, the day (4) (relate) to religious celebrations. For example, in Britain and Ireland, Mother’s Day coincides with Mothering Sunday, a day to honour the church where someone is baptised. The celebration falls on the fourth Sunday of Lent, three weeks before Easter Sunday. This year, it took place on March 27.

And in some Southeast Asian countries, Mother’s Day commemorates important historical figures and events. Thailand observes the celebration on 12 August, the birthday of Queen Sirikit, who (5) (regard) as the “Mother of Thailand”. Mother’s Day in Indonesia is on 22 December to honour the first Indonesian Women’s Congress which convened on that day in 1928 to fight for women’s rights.

What is the origin of the celebration?

The earliest form of Mother’s Day can be traced to ancient Egypt, where an annual festival was held for Isis, a popular goddess and representation of the ideal mother and wife. Centuries later in ancient Greece, the mother of all gods, Rhea, (6) (worship) through a festival every spring, during which people would make offerings of honey cakes, flowers, and expensive drinks.

In the United Kingdom, Mothering Sunday goes back to the Middle Ages, when Christians would return to their “mother church” where they were baptised and became “children of God”. Over time, it became a day when children who worked far from home could return to visit their mothers; during this time, it (7) (be) common for kids as young as 10 to leave home for work.

The Mother’s Day celebrated in Hong Kong and many other places around the world (8) (stem) from a devoted daughter in the United States. In 1908, Anna Jarvis started the tradition to honour how devoted mothers are to their children, as she (9) (inspire) by the life of her late mother who was an activist and social worker.

In May of that year, the first Mother’s Day was held at a church, where Jarvis handed out carnations, her mother’s favourite flower. Its popularity grew as Jarvis organised campaigns to make the celebration an official day. In 1914, President Woodrow Wilson declared the second Sunday in May (10) (be) Mother’s Day “as a public expression of love and reverence for the mothers of our country”.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

B. Vocabulary (5 marks)

Choose the most suitable words from the table below to complete the sentences. You may need to change the form of the words. Each word should only be used **once**.

abrasion	seismic	magnet	succumb	propeller
aptitude	glacier	rejuvenate	altitude	chaotic

Ash and aviation

Airports in Britain were closed from April 14 to 20 due to the eruption in Iceland. Other European countries followed suit for safety reasons, but why? How can tiny ash particles have such a great impact on the world?

The Icelandic volcanic eruption was unique as lava met (1) ice when it shot out the volcano. Ash combined with heat and cooling iced water turned the magma into a powdery mixture of extremely sharp, glass-like particles. These particles had strong (2) power and people encountering such ash would feel like they were being sandblasted.

Since these particles would be sucked into the engine of a plane and coat the turbines, the engine would stop functioning and stop (3) the plane, likely causing a crash. There was a similar situation when a British Airways flight flew over an ash cloud in Malaysia. Passengers saw flames come from the engine and go around the plane. Luckily the aircraft lowered its (4) and landed immediately and no one was hurt.

Director Sigfússon suggests an action plan be drawn up to prevent (5) again the next time there is a volcanic eruption in Iceland. "Wind usually blows from west to east, which pushes ash plumes to Europe. We have to remember that Iceland is a young country with 22 volcanoes. We have to be prepared for possible eruptions that might have a global impact in the future."

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

C. Parts of Speech (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate forms of the words in brackets.

Police on an anti-smuggling operation have confiscated more than 120 kittens and puppies (1) (legal) shipped into Hong Kong by speedboat from mainland China.

The 84 kittens and 42 puppies were found inside 46 crates on the speedboat, which a smuggler abandoned when chased, in the city's north-western Ha Pak Lai coastal area in Lau Fau Shan at about 11:30 pm on Sunday, police said.

The pet smuggler, who was in the speedboat alone, ran ashore and managed to escape, the force said on Monday.

"The pets were found crammed into the 46 crates and some of them were showing signs of (2) (dehydrate) ," said acting chief inspector Wong Shun-wai, an (3) (assist) Marine West divisional commander.

He said all of the animals had been handed over to the Agriculture, Fisheries and Conservation Department.

Senior Inspector Chan Ling of the marine police regional crime unit said the investigation suggested some of the animals were (4) (intention) for selling to local pet shops. He said he believed a smuggling syndicate was behind the illegal delivery of the animals from the mainland, adding that an investigation was underway.

A force insider said all of the kittens and puppies were expensive breeds and only a few months old, with each animal (5) (ability) to fetch thousands of dollars in Hong Kong.

A high-speed sea (6) (pursue) began when the speedboat with a man on board was seen in Deep Bay after entering Hong Kong waters from the mainland at about 11:30 pm on Sunday.

Wong said the man aboard the speedboat refused to stop and (7) (acceleration) after a police craft was deployed to intercept it.

After a brief chase, the smuggler berthed the boat at the coastal area in Ha Pak Lai, abandoned it and ran ashore to escape.

It was the third smuggling case involving kittens and puppies being shipped into Hong Kong from the mainland this year.

In May, 136 pedigree kittens and puppies were confiscated aboard a speedboat off Black Point in Tuen Mun, making it the city's (8) (large) seizure of pets in an anti-smuggling operation so far.

The 101 kittens and 35 puppies, all expensive breeds, were found inside 17 plastic crates on the speedboat late on 28 May, following a high-speed chase with police in north-western waters.

During the (9) (jointly) operation mounted by police and customs, a 30-year-old man, who had been alone on the 10-metre-long (33-foot) boat, was arrested aboard the vessel.

In January, 30 kittens and seven puppies were confiscated along with HK \$4.1 million (US \$522,283) worth of contraband containing (10) (freeze) deer tails – goods used for medicinal purposes – at the Ha Pak Lai coastal area.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

D. Modal Verbs (5 marks)

Decide which of the choices would best complete the text if inserted in the blanks. Write the **letter** of each answer in the space provided.

Calvin & Justin	Good morning, teachers. (1) I speak to Miss Lam?
Miss Lam	Good day, boys. What can I help you with?
Calvin	Hello, Miss Lam. We are aware that we must submit our artwork by Wednesday. In fact, we're still working on it. We know that we (2) working earlier. However, we had another group presentation last week.
Justin	We'd like to know if we can use plastic products and metal containers. (3) you mind explaining the project's rules to us?
Miss Lam	Well, basically, you can use any materials as long as they are recycled. If possible, you (4) even use old clothes from home.
Calvin	Oh, that's good advice. We will finish the artwork as soon as possible.
Miss Lam	Yes, it (5) be too difficult to find the appropriate materials. Actually, you can see plenty of them here at school as well. I'm looking forward to seeing your work. If you have no further questions, I'll see you tomorrow.
Calvin & Justin	We hope you'll like it. Goodbye and thank you, Miss Lam.

1. A. May B. Might C. Would D. Will	2. A. must have begun B. can't have begun C. should have begun D. may have begun	3. A. Could B. Will C. Would D. Might
4. A. ought B. may C. had better D. will	5. A. shouldn't B. may not C. mustn't D. don't have to	

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
----	----	----	----	----

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

E. Question Tags (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with suitable question tags.

Paul	You'd like to throw a birthday party for Ella next week, (1)?
Phoebe	Yes. We'll have to tell everyone about it today, (2)?
Paul	Let's invite Patrick and Anne, (3)?
Phoebe	Good idea. They said they'd like to prepare some decorations, (4)?
Paul	Oh, yes, such as balloons and banners. How about food? You have a talent for baking cakes, (5)?
Phoebe	Well, cooking is my hobby. You can prepare food, too. Nothing is impossible, (6)?
Paul	You're right. Last year, there was a lot of leftover food from the party, (7)?
Phoebe	Yes, I made far too much food. On top of that, I ordered a few more pizzas. You remember it, (8)?
Paul	Sure thing. You're not going to make so much food this year, (9)?
Phoebe	Yes, I am definitely not going to order pizzas this year.
Paul	By the way, you won't invite our neighbours, (10)? I really can't stand them.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

F. Multiple-choice Cloze (10 marks)

Read the following text. Decide which of the choices would best complete the text if inserted into the blanks. Write the **letter** of each answer in the space provided.

Money Talks

Society has changed a lot since the early days of bartering, when a farmer might trade a bag of vegetables for a set of new horseshoes from a (1). Now transactions can happen in a (2) second and it seems like anything and everything is up for sale, from virtual coins to school essays. *What Money Can't Buy: The Moral Limits of Markets* asks whether society has gone too far in its pursuit of making money.

Price tag

Almost every aspect of modern life has been invaded by market forces, fuelled by entrepreneurs seeking money-making opportunities. Things that were previously seen as priceless can now be bought by the highest bidder. For example, an education at a top university can now be obtained at a premium cost, while the right to emit greenhouse gases can be granted (3) carbon credits. The opening up of new markets has been brought on by enormous social and political changes. Gone is the 'market economy' system of your parents' generation and in its place is a 'market society' where everything has a price.

Advertising space

Businesses are now highly sophisticated at spotting marketing opportunities in some of the wildest and most (4) places. Popular sport has become unrecognisable from 30 years ago, when athletes were just ordinary people rather than celebrities. Now we have sports stadiums named (5) businesses, and sporting superstars are now highly valuable commodities with multimillion-dollar image rights and (6). Where has all the romance gone?

Not for sale

What Money Can't Buy asks readers whether this worrying trend of commercialisation should continue and whether everything should be available for sale. It questions whether the relationship between morality and economics is determined too much by big business. What will the growing market society mean for traditional (7) and ethical standards, and will certain sections of society be disadvantaged? One of the (8) examples given in the book is a queue in a museum, and someone paying for another person to wait in line for them. In this scenario, is it right to control (9) to culture and knowledge based on a person's wealth rather than on their ability to wait patiently? The book suggests that some things in life are perhaps too important, too personal or too controversial to be sold on the open market. These include paying mercenaries to fight wars, using prison inmates as cheap labour, and selling citizenship to immigrants.

A critical look

The book comes to the conclusion that many governments' economic principles have been compromised over the years for the good of the free market. The author appeals for a return of moral values in public life. He also warns that the rush to put a price on everything has affected poor people the most, with some being priced out of the market. The book is easy to read, full of fascinating and surprising facts, and will (10) economic experts as well as concerned consumers.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

1. A. jockey B. blacksmith C. breeder D. butcher	2. A. flash B. blink C. fraction D. split	3. A. thanks to B. as a result C. due with D. because
4. A. typical B. conventional C. orthodox D. unusual	5. A. after B. in honour C. before D. under	6. A. employment B. entitlements C. endorsements D. entertainment
7. A. mortal B. moral C. morale D. mortar	8. A. hypothesis B. hypothesize C. hypothesise D. hypothetical	9. A. assess B. assessible C. access D. accessible
10. A. appeal to B. appeal C. attract to D. attrack		

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

G. Reported Speech (10 marks)

Change the following direct speech into reported speech.

'Does anyone wish to join the E-learning talk after school tomorrow?' Paul asked.
'I must join the talk and please wait for me after the last lesson,' Lina replied.
'Can I come a bit late after I finish the Geography worksheet Mr Wong gave us this afternoon?' asked Marco.
'You can. Remember to hand it in next Thursday,' Paul said.

Paul asked (1) _____

Lina replied (2) _____

and asked Paul (3) _____

Marco asked (4) _____

Paul said (5) _____ and reminded him _____

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

H. Proofreading (10 marks)

Proofread the following text (numbered lines 1-10 only) without changing the meaning. No lines have more than one mistake and at least one line is correct. Do not make any changes to punctuation and do not make unnecessary changes. Use ONE word only for each correction. If you think there are no mistakes in a line, put a ✓ at the end of the line (example c).

Corrections must be done as follows:

Extra word: delete the extra word with a 'X' (example a).

Missing word: mark the position of the missing word with a '^' and write the missing word above it (example b).

Wrong word: underline the wrong word and write the correct word above it (example d).

a	When I was younger, my friends and I would X try to scare each other
b	by telling ghost stories. I never got frightened because I did not believe ^ ghosts.
c	In fact, I would laugh at anyone who said they did. However, I changed my ✓
d	mind about this last summer when I was staying <u>at</u> my aunt in Guangzhou.

- 1 Hong Kong is famous of being a fast-developing and ever-changing city, but it's the things that
2 have stuck around over the decades that have become iconic. Sadly, even these symbolic
3 elements are starting to disappear, and are being replaced by modern alternatives.
4 Since 1940s, bright neon signs have lit up the streets of Hong Kong,
5 forming an instantly recognisable part of the city identity. You can find them
6 hang above everything, from jewellery stores to hotels to local restaurants. However, in the
7 last few years, the beloved neon billboards have been disappearing at staggering rates.
8 Some claim that around 1,000 neon signs are being taken down each years, and are being
9 replaced with cheaper, brighter, and energy-efficient LED signs. Although this is a
10 better move for the planet, we can't say we won't miss the neon glow at night.

END OF PAPER

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.